

\$60k Self-Pay: Toward IUL vs. Straight into SPY

\$5M IUL | You pay \$60k/yr for 10 yrs | Compare at Year 25 (age 70) | No tax assumptions | 3 historical windows

Option A — Pay \$60k/yr INTO the IUL

You pay \$60,000/yr out of pocket for 10 years = \$600,000 total The remaining \$206,675/yr is financed by the lender Total premium \$266,675/yr still goes into the policy → Smaller loan = more surplus after repayment at Year 20 → Policy continues growing, you draw income from Year 21 → \$5M death benefit the whole time

Option B — Skip the \$60k, invest in SPY instead

You invest \$60,000/yr directly into S&P; 500 for 10 years = \$600,000 total Full S&P; 500 returns — no cap, no floor, no policy charges Let it compound untouched through Year 25 (age 70) → Pure market returns on your \$600k → No IUL, no death benefit, no tax-free income → But full upside exposure to the market

1. WHAT YOU HAVE AT YEAR 25 (AGE 70) — ALL THREE SCENARIOS

Scenario	Years	Your cash invested	IUL Value @ Year 20	IUL Value @ Year 25	SPY Value @ Year 25	Winner @ Year 25	IUL Advantage (extra you keep)
SCENARIO A	2005–2024	\$600,000	\$5,337,035	\$7,084,801	\$3,944,939	IUL	\$3,139,862
SCENARIO B	2003–2022	\$600,000	\$4,692,938	\$6,977,460	\$3,770,806	IUL	\$3,206,654
SCENARIO C	2000–2019	\$600,000	\$3,986,035	\$6,178,022	\$2,986,887	IUL	\$3,191,134

SCENARIO A: 2005–2024 — Best case — GFC + COVID recovery

Your total invested: \$600,000		IUL @ Year 25: \$7,084,801		SPY @ Year 25: \$3,944,939		IUL wins by \$3,139,862			
Yr	Age	Cal	S&P; Return	Credited (IUL)	Loan Rate	Loan Balance	IUL Value	SPY Value	IUL vs SPY (difference)
1	46	2005	3.0%	3.0%	4.22%	\$215,397	\$270,675	\$61,800	\$208,875
2	47	2006	13.6%	13.5%	6.32%	\$448,747	\$601,832	\$138,389	\$463,443
3	48	2007	3.5%	3.5%	6.02%	\$694,878	\$886,138	\$205,392	\$680,746
4	49	2008	-38.5%	0.0%	3.13%	\$929,772	\$1,135,521	\$163,243	\$972,278
5	50	2009	23.4%	13.5%	1.24%	\$1,150,539	\$1,570,459	\$275,593	\$1,294,866
6	51	2010	12.8%	12.8%	1.29%	\$1,374,722	\$2,044,363	\$378,482	\$1,665,881
7	52	2011	0.0%	0.0%	1.25%	\$1,601,164	\$2,276,372	\$438,482	\$1,837,890
8	53	2012	13.4%	13.4%	1.31%	\$1,831,522	\$2,845,924	\$565,328	\$2,280,596
9	54	2013	29.6%	13.5%	1.24%	\$2,063,470	\$3,486,111	\$810,426	\$2,675,685
10	55	2014	11.4%	11.4%	1.23%	\$2,298,068	\$4,123,937	\$969,567	\$3,154,369
11	56	2015	-0.7%	0.0%	1.32%	\$2,328,403	\$4,062,078	\$962,489	\$3,099,588
12	57	2016	9.5%	9.5%	1.97%	\$2,374,272	\$4,388,669	\$1,054,311	\$3,334,358
13	58	2017	19.4%	13.5%	2.30%	\$2,428,880	\$4,915,309	\$1,259,058	\$3,656,251
14	59	2018	-6.2%	0.0%	3.36%	\$2,510,491	\$4,841,579	\$1,180,493	\$3,661,086
15	60	2019	28.9%	13.5%	3.16%	\$2,589,822	\$5,422,569	\$1,521,419	\$3,901,150
16	61	2020	16.3%	13.5%	1.37%	\$2,625,303	\$6,073,277	\$1,768,802	\$4,304,475

Yr	Age	Cal	S&P; Return	Credited (IUL)	Loan Rate	Loan Balance	IUL Value	SPY Value	IUL vs SPY (difference)
17	62	2021	26.9%	13.5%	1.05%	\$2,652,869	\$6,802,070	\$2,244,433	\$4,557,638
18	63	2022	-19.4%	0.0%	3.28%	\$2,739,883	\$6,700,039	\$1,808,115	\$4,891,924
19	64	2023	24.2%	13.5%	6.02%	\$2,904,824	\$7,504,044	\$2,246,221	\$5,257,823
20	65	2024	23.3%	13.5%	5.60%	Repaid	\$5,337,035	\$2,769,815	\$2,567,220
21	66	2025	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$5,648,142	\$2,972,821	\$2,675,321
22	67	2026	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$5,977,383	\$3,190,705	\$2,786,679
23	68	2027	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$6,325,817	\$3,424,558	\$2,901,259
24	69	2028	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$6,694,562	\$3,675,551	\$3,019,011
25	70	2029	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$7,084,801	\$3,944,939	\$3,139,862

SCENARIO B: 2003–2022 — Middle — Dot-com recovery to COVID crash

Your total invested: \$600,000	IUL @ Year 25: \$6,977,460	SPY @ Year 25: \$3,770,806	IUL wins by \$3,206,654
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Yr	Age	Cal	S&P; Return	Credited (IUL)	Loan Rate	Loan Balance	IUL Value	SPY Value	IUL vs SPY (difference)
1	46	2003	26.4%	13.5%	2.12%	\$211,057	\$298,676	\$75,828	\$222,848
2	47	2004	9.0%	9.0%	2.56%	\$428,425	\$607,696	\$148,039	\$459,657
3	48	2005	3.0%	3.0%	4.22%	\$661,902	\$887,486	\$214,280	\$673,206
4	49	2006	13.6%	13.5%	6.32%	\$923,471	\$1,292,661	\$311,637	\$981,024
5	50	2007	3.5%	3.5%	6.02%	\$1,198,180	\$1,590,990	\$384,756	\$1,206,234
6	51	2008	-38.5%	0.0%	3.13%	\$1,448,827	\$1,829,800	\$273,569	\$1,556,231
7	52	2009	23.4%	13.5%	1.24%	\$1,676,031	\$2,348,052	\$411,791	\$1,936,261
8	53	2010	12.8%	12.8%	1.29%	\$1,906,993	\$2,909,669	\$532,086	\$2,377,582
9	54	2011	0.0%	0.0%	1.25%	\$2,140,088	\$3,128,698	\$592,086	\$2,536,612
10	55	2012	13.4%	13.4%	1.31%	\$2,377,506	\$3,799,762	\$739,531	\$3,060,231
11	56	2013	29.6%	13.5%	1.24%	\$2,406,987	\$4,255,734	\$958,432	\$3,297,302
12	57	2014	11.4%	11.4%	1.23%	\$2,436,593	\$4,676,626	\$1,067,598	\$3,609,028
13	58	2015	-0.7%	0.0%	1.32%	\$2,468,756	\$4,606,476	\$1,059,804	\$3,546,672
14	59	2016	9.5%	9.5%	1.97%	\$2,517,391	\$4,976,837	\$1,160,909	\$3,815,928
15	60	2017	19.4%	13.5%	2.30%	\$2,575,291	\$5,574,058	\$1,386,358	\$4,187,700
16	61	2018	-6.2%	0.0%	3.36%	\$2,661,820	\$5,490,447	\$1,299,849	\$4,190,597
17	62	2019	28.9%	13.5%	3.16%	\$2,745,934	\$6,149,300	\$1,675,246	\$4,474,055
18	63	2020	16.3%	13.5%	1.37%	\$2,783,553	\$6,887,216	\$1,947,641	\$4,939,576
19	64	2021	26.9%	13.5%	1.05%	\$2,812,780	\$7,713,682	\$2,471,361	\$5,242,321
20	65	2022	-19.4%	0.0%	3.28%	Repaid	\$4,692,938	\$1,990,929	\$2,702,009
21	66	2023	24.2%	13.5%	6.02%	Repaid	\$5,256,090	\$2,473,331	\$2,782,759
22	67	2024	23.3%	13.5%	5.60%	Repaid	\$5,886,821	\$3,049,864	\$2,836,957
23	68	2025	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$6,229,975	\$3,273,395	\$2,956,581
24	69	2026	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$6,593,133	\$3,513,309	\$3,079,825

Yr	Age	Cal	S&P; Return	Credited (IUL)	Loan Rate	Loan Balance	IUL Value	SPY Value	IUL vs SPY (difference)
25	70	2027	7.3%	7.3%	3.05%	Repaid	\$6,977,460	\$3,770,806	\$3,206,654

SCENARIO C: 2000–2019 — Worst — Dot-com crash + GFC back-to-back

Your total invested: \$600,000	IUL @ Year 25: \$6,178,022	SPY @ Year 25: \$2,986,887	IUL wins by \$3,191,134
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Yr	Age	Cal	S&P; Return	Credited (IUL)	Loan Rate	Loan Balance	IUL Value	SPY Value	IUL vs SPY (difference)
1	46	2000	-10.1%	0.0%	7.52%	\$222,217	\$262,675	\$53,916	\$208,759
2	47	2001	-13.0%	0.0%	4.50%	\$448,192	\$521,410	\$99,061	\$422,348
3	48	2002	-23.4%	0.0%	2.80%	\$673,203	\$776,263	\$121,889	\$654,375
4	49	2003	26.4%	13.5%	2.12%	\$898,532	\$1,168,091	\$229,871	\$938,220
5	50	2004	9.0%	9.0%	2.56%	\$1,133,500	\$1,542,230	\$315,930	\$1,226,300
6	51	2005	3.0%	3.0%	4.22%	\$1,396,730	\$1,836,039	\$387,208	\$1,448,830
7	52	2006	13.6%	13.5%	6.32%	\$1,704,741	\$2,355,039	\$508,118	\$1,846,921
8	53	2007	3.5%	3.5%	6.02%	\$2,026,483	\$2,674,935	\$588,173	\$2,086,762
9	54	2008	-38.5%	0.0%	3.13%	\$2,303,056	\$2,897,486	\$398,691	\$2,498,795
10	55	2009	23.4%	13.5%	1.24%	\$2,540,851	\$3,543,860	\$566,254	\$2,977,606
11	56	2010	12.8%	12.8%	1.29%	\$2,573,628	\$3,943,607	\$638,621	\$3,304,986
12	57	2011	0.0%	0.0%	1.25%	\$2,605,799	\$3,884,453	\$638,621	\$3,245,832
13	58	2012	13.4%	13.4%	1.31%	\$2,639,935	\$4,347,092	\$724,260	\$3,622,831
14	59	2013	29.6%	13.5%	1.24%	\$2,672,670	\$4,868,743	\$938,641	\$3,930,101
15	60	2014	11.4%	11.4%	1.23%	\$2,705,544	\$5,350,261	\$1,045,553	\$4,304,709
16	61	2015	-0.7%	0.0%	1.32%	\$2,741,257	\$5,270,008	\$1,037,920	\$4,232,087
17	62	2016	9.5%	9.5%	1.97%	\$2,795,260	\$5,693,716	\$1,136,938	\$4,556,778
18	63	2017	19.4%	13.5%	2.30%	\$2,859,551	\$6,376,962	\$1,357,731	\$5,019,231
19	64	2018	-6.2%	0.0%	3.36%	\$2,955,632	\$6,281,308	\$1,273,009	\$5,008,299
20	65	2019	28.9%	13.5%	3.16%	Repaid	\$3,986,035	\$1,640,654	\$2,345,381
21	66	2020	16.3%	13.5%	1.37%	Repaid	\$4,464,359	\$1,907,424	\$2,556,935
22	67	2021	26.9%	13.5%	1.05%	Repaid	\$5,000,082	\$2,420,330	\$2,579,752
23	68	2022	-19.4%	0.0%	3.28%	Repaid	\$4,925,081	\$1,949,818	\$2,975,263
24	69	2023	24.2%	13.5%	6.02%	Repaid	\$5,516,091	\$2,422,259	\$3,093,832
25	70	2024	23.3%	13.5%	5.60%	Repaid	\$6,178,022	\$2,986,887	\$3,191,134

2. THE FULL PICTURE — WHAT DOES EACH OPTION ACTUALLY GIVE YOU?

	Option A: \$60k into IUL	Option B: \$60k into SPY
Your cash invested (10 yrs)	\$600,000	\$600,000
Value at Year 25 — Best case	\$7,084,801	\$3,944,939
Value at Year 25 — Middle case	\$6,977,460	\$3,770,806

Value at Year 25 — Worst case	\$6,178,022	\$2,986,887
IUL advantage at Year 25	\$3.1M – \$3.2M MORE than SPY	—
Why IUL wins here	The \$600k reduces the loan AND the full \$266,675/yr premium still compounds in the policy — you get leverage on \$266k but only paid \$60k	Your \$60k grows to \$3–4M. No leverage. No compounding on borrowed money.
Death benefit (Yrs 1–20+)	\$5,000,000 (income-tax-free to heirs)	\$0
Tax-free income from Year 21	Yes — ongoing policy loans, no tax	No — SPY gains taxable on withdrawal
Downside protection	0% floor — policy never loses value from market crashes	Full downside exposure — 2008 your \$60k could drop 38%
2008 crash impact	IUL credited 0% — held stable	SPY lost 38.5% — your balance cratered

BOTTOM LINE: Putting your \$60k/yr into the IUL (reducing the loan) produces 1.7x–2.4x MORE total value at Year 25 compared to investing that same \$60k directly in SPY. The reason: in the IUL your \$60k reduces the loan but the full \$266,675 premium still compounds in the policy — you are essentially getting \$4.45 of compounding asset for every \$1 you put in (leverage from the borrowed portion). SPY gives you only \$1 of compounding for every \$1 invested. Add in the \$5M death benefit and tax-free income, and the IUL contribution is the better use of your \$60k.

S&P; 500 price returns and SOFR from public historical data. Policy charges ~1.5%/yr proxy. Cap 13.5%, Floor 0%. Tax implications excluded. \$5M policy, age 45 start. Not financial advice.